



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 50

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Asbestos Awareness for Interior Renovation

OVERVIEW:

Asbestos-containing materials were used extensively in building construction from the 1940s through the late 1980s. Asbestos fibers released by disturbing ACM are the cause of mesothelioma — an aggressive cancer of the lining of the lungs — and asbestosis, a progressive and incurable scarring of the lung

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. Asbestos-containing materials that may be encountered during interior renovation include: floor tiles and floor tile adhesives (especially 9x9 and 12x12 vinyl floor tiles manufactured before 1980), ceiling tiles including acoustic ceiling tiles, pipe and duct insulation including duct wrap and pipe lagging, drywall joint compound manufactured before 1977, spray-applied fireproofing on
2. The defining rule for asbestos is this: do not disturb it. Asbestos that is in good condition and not being disturbed does not release fibers into the air in hazardous quantities. The hazard occurs when ACM is cut, sanded, scraped, drilled, demolished, or otherwise physically disturbed. If you encounter a suspected ACM and are not certain it is safe, stop work, mark the area, and contact
3. Only licensed and accredited asbestos abatement contractors are legally permitted to remove ACM from a building in the United States. This is a federal requirement under the Clean Air Act and OSHA standard 1926.1101. The abatement process requires containment, negative air pressure, worker protection with supplied-air respirators, and waste disposal in labeled containers at licensed
4. If you discover a material during demolition or renovation that you believe may contain asbestos — regardless of what the project documents say — stop work in that area immediately. The cost of remediation is always less than the cost of an asbestos release event in terms of health consequences, regulatory penalties, and remediation expenses. Your instinct to stop and report is

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

- Q1: Are there any areas on this project where asbestos survey results are available? Has the building been tested?
Q2: What does a suspicious asbestos-containing material look like, and what do you do when you find it?

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Stop work immediately if you encounter suspicious material during renovation
- Do NOT disturb, drill, cut, or sand any suspected asbestos-containing material
- Report all suspected ACM to your supervisor and await professional testing
- Only licensed asbestos abatement contractors can legally remove ACM
- Asbestos-related disease symptoms appear 20-50 years after exposure

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 50

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

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